PLAYBOOK

The Dormant Database Audit

A practical playbook for real estate principals: how to estimate, audit, and reactivate the leads sitting dead in your CRM.

$345k	4	10	15 min
AVG LATENT VALUE	REVENUE STREAMS	AUDIT ITEMS	TO COMPLETE

By Think ALM

01 · THE PREMISE

Most agencies are sitting on a dormant database worth more than their annual revenue.

A mid-size Australian agency processes thousands of buyer enquiries, vendor leads, rental applications, and appraisal requests every year. Of those, the highest-intent 5 to 10 percent become transactions in the first 90 days. The other 90 to 95 percent get logged in the CRM, sent a handful of follow-ups, and forgotten.

After three to five years of normal operations, the database holds tens of thousands of records. Each one represents a person who, at some point, raised their hand. Each one represents latent commission. Almost none of them are being actively worked.

> *The hard problem in real estate is not lead generation. It is lead reactivation.*

This guide is the audit. In the next seven pages, you will calculate the latent pipeline value sitting in your CRM, score your database health against a 10-point rubric, identify which of the four revenue streams in your data are most extractable, and understand why most reactivation attempts fail.

If you finish the audit and want a conversation about extracting that value, the final page tells you how to book one. If you finish and just keep the playbook, that is also fine. The math is yours either way.

02 · CALCULATE YOUR DATABASE VALUE

The math is simple. Most owners just never run it.

For each revenue stream in your CRM, estimate three numbers: the total lead count, the realistic conversion rate when the stream is worked systematically, and the average value per conversion. Multiply. Sum across streams. That number is your dormant pipeline.

WORKED EXAMPLE · 12,000-LEAD DATABASE

STREAM	LEADS	CONV.	AVG VALUE	LATENT VALUE
Appraisal-eligible vendors	1,800	0.36%	$24,000	$155,520
Buyer pipeline	5,400	0.30%	$8,000	$129,600
Rental → property mgmt	3,200	0.50%	$2,800/yr	$44,800/yr
Vendor referrals (modelled)	—	—	—	~$15,000/yr
TOTAL	**12,000**	**—**	**—**	**≈ $345,000**

These benchmarks reflect what is observed in active reactivation deployments across mid-size Australian agencies, applied conservatively. The actual number for your database may be materially higher. Now run the math on yours.

03 · YOUR NUMBERS

Run the math on your own CRM.

Fill in your best estimate for each stream. If you don't know the lead count, pull it from your CRM today. If you don't know the conversion rate, use the benchmark from page 2 as a starting point.

STREAM	LEADS	CONV.	AVG VALUE	LATENT VALUE
Appraisal-eligible vendors				
Buyer pipeline				
Rental → property mgmt				
Vendor referrals (modelled)				
TOTAL				

> *If your total is larger than your current annual GCI, the database is the most under-exploited asset in your business.*

04 · FOUR REVENUE STREAMS HIDING IN YOUR CRM

Not every lead is worth the same. Work the high-leverage streams first.

01. Appraisal-eligible vendors

The highest-value stream. Past appraisals, off-market enquiries, expired campaigns, vendors who didn't list 12 to 24 months ago. Many have re-entered the market and don't remember which agency they spoke to first. The agency that re-engages first wins.

02. Buyer pipeline

Medium-value, faster cycle. Buyer enquiries from old campaigns, inspection registrations, contact form fills. Most have either bought, lost interest, or are still looking quietly. The still-looking segment is gold and almost never re-worked.

03. Rental enquiries → property management

The most overlooked stream. Tenants who applied for rentals through your agency are often investors or future investors. Rental records frequently include landlords looking for management. Recurring revenue, sticky, often more profitable per hour than sales.

04. Vendor referrals

The compound multiplier. Every transaction from a reactivated lead typically carries 0.5 to 1.0 referral on average. This is the stream that turns reactivation from a campaign into a system — the database grows from itself.

05 · DATABASE HEALTH SCORECARD

Score each item 0 or 1. Tally your total at the bottom.

#	ITEM	0	1
DATA QUALITY			
1	Lead records include phone numbers for at least 70% of contacts		
2	Lead records are tagged by source and intent		
3	Duplicate records have been merged in the last 12 months		
ACTIVITY			
4	Every lead has been contacted at least once in the last 18 months		
5	There is a documented follow-up sequence for inactive leads		
6	The CRM is the system of record — not spreadsheets or email folders		
SYSTEMS			
7	Outbound is logged automatically (calls, SMS, email)		
8	Booked appointments flow directly into agent calendars		
9	Lead status is updated by the system, not by humans		
10	There is automated re-engagement on stale records		

INTERPRETING YOUR SCORE

0–3 Critical. The database is structurally unworked. Reactivation is the highest-leverage move available to you this year.

4–6 Underperforming. Significant latent value present but not being captured. A reactivation system would extract it quickly.

7–9 Healthy. Database is being worked but not optimised. Incremental gains possible.

10 Best in class. No action required on database. Focus growth elsewhere.

06 · WHY MOST REACTIVATION ATTEMPTS FAIL

Three failure modes account for almost every collapsed programme we audit.

01. Manual outbound

An agency hires SDRs or shifts existing agents to work the database. Productive for two months, the approach collapses by month three. SDRs at $70k–$90k plus super burn through the easy leads, hit a wall on the cold ones, and resign. Existing agents prioritise current listings over cold callbacks every time. The database remains unworked.

02. Bulk SMS and email blasts

The CRM offers a send-to-all function. The agency uses it. Open rates collapse, deliverability tanks, domain reputation suffers, and the few responses are tire-kickers and unsubscribes. The leads who were genuinely warm get burned by impersonal contact.

03. Outsourced call centres

A generalist call centre is contracted to dial the list. Script-driven, no CRM access, no integration. Leads who express intent get logged in a spreadsheet, emailed to the agency, and lost on handoff. Conversion is poor, the brand experience is worse, and the list gets damaged in the process.

> *The pattern across all three: the reactivation effort lives outside the CRM. Without integration, qualified leads leak.*

07 · WHAT MODERN REACTIVATION LOOKS LIKE

A system that actually works has four properties.

01. CRM-native

The system lives inside the CRM the agency already uses. Booked appointments appear in agent calendars exactly the way they always have. CRM records update automatically. No handoffs, no parallel systems, no lost leads.

02. Conversational

Contact happens through human-like voice and messaging, not broadcast templates. The agent reads each lead's history before opening the conversation. It handles objections in real time. It qualifies before booking.

03. Always-on

The system works 24/7, doesn't take leave, doesn't churn, doesn't have bad days. It operates at consistent quality whether the list is 100 leads or 100,000.

04. Compounding

Every interaction enriches the CRM record. Every booked appointment generates pipeline. Every transaction generates referrals. The database becomes self-improving infrastructure.

> *This is what Think ALM builds. We deployed exactly this system for Forsyth Real Estate — a Sydney agency operating since 1924 — integrated directly into their Repit CRM.*

08 · NEXT STEP

If your audit score is 4 or below, your database has meaningful latent value and no current system to extract it.

That's the case where a conversation is worth your time.

Book your discovery call

15 minutes. We'll look at your CRM, your lead volume, and your current sales process — and tell you honestly whether the same approach we ran for Forsyth would work for your business. If it wouldn't, we'll say so.

→ **calendly.com/charlie-thinkalm/30min**

Think ALM works with a small number of clients per quarter so the work stays sharp and the results are real. There is no upsell on this call. Either we're a fit or we're not.

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